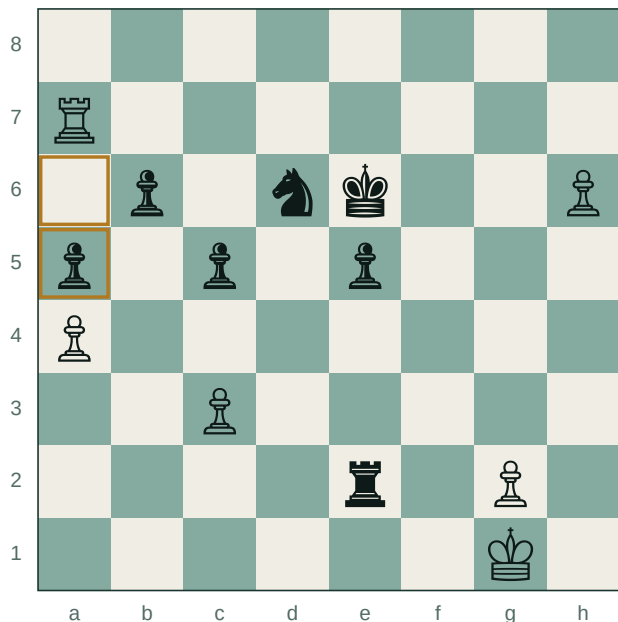


Promotion combinations: White, move 42

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 41...a5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

42. h7 Re1+ 43. Kh2 Nf7 44. Rxf7 Kxf7 45. h8=Q

42.h7 The pawn moves from h6 to h7. Recorded reply: **42...Re1+**.

43.Kh2 The king moves from g1 to h2. Recorded reply: **43...Nf7**.

44.Rxf7 The rook captures the knight on f7. Recorded reply: **44...Kxf7**.

45.h8=Q The pawn moves from h7 to h8. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on e6. Geometrically undefended: rook on e2. Check for tactical protection.